



CREWQCI · USER GUIDE

How to use CrewQCI.

Every page of the app, step by step — from your first sign-in to invoices, applications for payment, retentions and the credit control that chases the money for you. Each chapter ends with fixes for the things that trip people up.

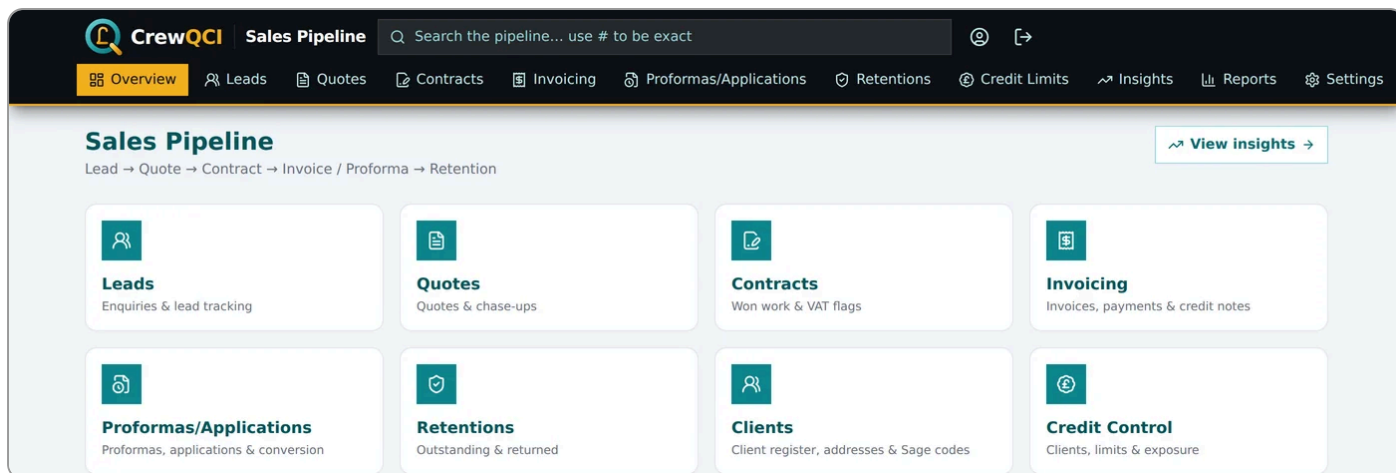
Updated **August 2026** Applies to **CrewQCI on the web and installed**

Also available in print — download below

1. What CrewQCI is

CrewQCI runs the commercial side of a construction or trade business from first enquiry to cleared payment. One chain of records carries the whole story: a **lead** (an enquiry) becomes a **quote** (a price), a won quote becomes a **contract** (the job), and against the contract you raise **invoices, credit notes, proformas and applications for payment** as branded PDFs. From there, **credit control** chases the money for you — reminders, chasers, statements and retention requests, on a ladder you set.

Because it's one chain, nothing is retyped: details entered on the lead flow to the quote, the contract and every document, and a correction made once is pushed everywhere. Everyone in your company works from the same registers at the same time — two people can be in it at once without overwriting each other.



The Overview — every part of the pipeline one click away.

READING THIS GUIDE

Names in boxes, like **Add Quote**, are the exact buttons and fields you'll see in the app. Paths like **Settings** → **Prospecting** mean: open Settings, then find the Prospecting card. Use the search box in the contents panel to jump straight to any topic — it searches everything, including the troubleshooting entries.

2. Creating your account and signing in

Everyone gets their own personal login. There are two ways in:

[Continue with Google](#) (one step, no password to remember) or an email address and password.

Registering with an email address

- 1 Go to crew-qci.com (<https://crew-qci.com>) and click [Start Free Trial](#), then [Create one](#) on the sign-in page.
- 2 Enter your [Email](#), [Password](#) and [Confirm Password](#), then click [Create account](#).
- 3 On the [Verify your email](#) screen, type the 6-digit code from the email you've been sent.
Didn't get it? Click [Resend](#) — and check your spam folder.
- 4 Click [Verify](#) — you're signed in and taken into the app.

Signing in and out

Open the app while signed out and the [Welcome back](#) page appears: use [Continue with Google](#), or your email and password. To sign out, click the log-out icon at the top right of the header, or open the **Account** page (the round person icon) and click [Logout](#).

Forgotten your password?

- 1 On the sign-in page, click [Forgot password?](#).
- 2 Enter your [Email address](#) and click [Send reset link](#), then check your inbox.
- 3 Open the link, fill in [New Password](#) and [Confirm Password](#), and click [Reset password](#). Sign in with the new password.

SIGNED UP WITH GOOGLE?

There's no CrewQCI password on your account to reset — just use [Continue with Google](#) every time.

If something's not right

■ "Invalid email or password" when logging in

Re-type both carefully, or click [Forgot password?](#) to set a new one. If you originally registered with Google, use [Continue with Google](#) instead — there's no password on the account.

■ "Invalid verification code" when registering

The code was mistyped, or an older code was entered after a new one was requested.

Use the code from the *most recent* email, or click [Resend](#) for a fresh one.

■ No password-reset email arrives

The page shows the same confirmation whether or not the address has an account (for security) — so a typo, a Google-only account or a spam filter all look the same.

Check spam, confirm you typed the address you registered with, and remember Google sign-ins don't have a CrewQCI password.

■ "Invalid reset link" or "Failed to reset password"

The link was cut short by email software, has expired, or was already used.

Click [Request a new link](#) and use the fresh email — copy the whole link into the address bar if clicking doesn't work.

■ "Access Restricted — you are not registered to use this application"

The login you're using isn't registered for the app.

Check you're signed in with the right account (work vs personal Google accounts are the usual culprit), try logging out and back in, or contact your administrator for access.

3. Your company, the trial and subscribing

Every login belongs to one company workspace, and all your registers are private to your company. The *first* person from a business creates the company; everyone else joins it by invite. Creating a company also starts the whole team's card-free 14-day trial, and makes you the company Owner with full access.

Creating the company (first person only)

- 1 Sign in for the first time — the **Create your company** page appears automatically.
- 2 Type your business name in **Company name** and click **Create company**.
- 3 You're in, and the 14-day trial has started for your whole team — no card details taken.
- 4 Head to **Settings** and fill in your company details, so they print on your documents from day one.

JOINING AN EXISTING COMPANY?

Don't create a new one — that gives you a separate, empty workspace. Ask your administrator to invite your email address first, then just sign in with that exact address: the invite is claimed automatically and you land in your company's app.

When the trial ends

When neither the trial nor a subscription is active, the app shows the subscription page until someone on the team subscribes. One subscription covers the whole company — £55/month or £550/year (two months free), unlimited users.

- 1 On the subscription page, click the **Monthly** or **Annual** plan box, then **Start free trial**.
- 2 Complete the secure checkout page you're redirected to.
- 3 You return to a confirmation — "Confirming your payment...", then "You're all set". Click **Go to the pipeline**.

As soon as one person's payment confirms, the whole team is let in.

If something's not right

■ You were invited, but you see "Create your company"

No pending invite was found for the email you signed in with — it may have been sent to a different address, or not sent yet.

Don't create a company. Confirm with your administrator exactly which email was invited, and sign in with that address. Invites are matched on the email address, so the two must match.

■ "You already belong to a company"

Your login is already attached to a workspace.

Sign out and back in — you should land in your existing company.

■ The page stays on "Confirming your payment..."

Payment confirmation can lag a little behind the redirect; the page keeps checking for about 45 seconds.

As the page itself says, you can safely leave — the subscription finishes setting up either way. Sign in again a few minutes later; if you're still shown the subscription page, email Peter.

■ The team keeps seeing the subscription page after paying

No active subscription or live trial is being found for the company.

Ask whoever paid to confirm they reached "You're all set". If they did, sign out and back in; if it persists, email Peter.

4. Your team and who sees what

Colleagues are added by invitation, so everyone shares the same registers. An invite carries the access the person will get — their **access tier** and, optionally, a custom list of pages. The invited person simply registers (or signs in) with the invited email address and lands straight in the company.

ACCESS TIER	WHAT THEY SEE
Super Admin	Everything. Given automatically to the person who created the company.
Admin	Everything, including the money pages — credit control, aged debt, reports and insights.
Sales	The pipeline without company-wide money figures: Overview, Leads, Quotes, Contracts, Proformas & Applications, Clients, Search and Account.
Viewer	Looking, not running: Overview, Leads, Quotes, Contracts, Search and Account.

Separately from the tier, a user can be an **admin** — able to manage users and settings, and the only ones who can send invites. Your own tier is shown on the **Account** page under **Access tier**.

TIP

If a page or report you expect is missing, nothing has been lost — it's just not shown at your tier. Ask your administrator to check your access tier or allowed pages.

5. Installing CrewQCI on your phone or desktop

CrewQCI installs straight from the browser — no app store needed — and then works like a normal app from your home screen or taskbar.

- 1 Click **Install App** — on the website, or on the **Account** page's **Install CrewQCI** card.
- 2 Accept the browser's prompt.
- 3 On iPhone or iPad, use Safari instead: tap the Share icon, then **Add to Home Screen**.
- 4 No prompt? In Chrome or Edge it's under **Menu** → **Install CrewQCI**; in Safari, **File** → **Add to Home Screen**.

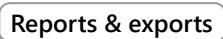
Installing changes nothing about your account or data — it's the same app, just quicker to reach.

6. Finding your way around

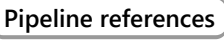
The quickest route to help is always the  button in the app's header: it opens this guide in a new tab, at the chapter for the page you're on.

After signing in you land on the **Sales Pipeline** overview — the flow "Lead → Quote → Contract → Invoice / Proforma → Retention" with a tile for every area: Leads, Quotes, Contracts, Invoicing, Proformas/Applications, Retentions, Clients, Credit Control, Settings and Reports, plus a  button for the charts. Which tiles work for you depends on your access tier.

The bar under the header carries the pages you work in all day: , , , , , , , ,  and . On a phone the same bar sits along the bottom of the screen. Two pages sit outside it:

- **Settings** — the  cog in the header, to the left of the  button. It's on every page, including on a phone.
- **Reports** — open  and click  at the top right. Insights is the at-a-glance picture; Reports is where a figure gets filtered, printed and sent. Both are also tiles on the Overview.

Search: one box for everything

The header search box — "Search the pipeline... use # to be exact" — finds leads, quotes, contracts, invoices, proformas, retentions and client accounts from one place. Press Enter for the results page, split into  and ; click any result to jump straight to the record on its own page.

- An ordinary search matches anywhere: reference numbers, client names, sites, sectors, contacts, emails, notes and feedback.
- Prefix with # (e.g. ) for an exact reference search — it matches the whole number only, so #653 will not return 6532.
- Searching a contract number also surfaces the quote it came from. Draft documents are excluded until issued.

TIP

To pull together everything on one job — contract, source quote, invoices, retentions, the original lead — search its number with #. One search, the whole story.

7. Working the registers

Leads, Quotes, Contracts, Invoicing and Proformas all share the same spreadsheet-style table, so one set of habits works everywhere.

- **Search** — type in the search box above the table. On the bigger registers the first search quietly fetches the complete history ("Loading all records..."), so results cover everything, not just recent rows.
- **Filter** — click any column header to filter its values, Excel-style: tick the values to show, or **Show all** to clear. Active filters appear as gold chips above the table; click a chip to remove it, or **Clear all filters**. Date columns filter by UK financial year (e.g. "FY 2025/26").
- **Columns** — the **Columns** button switches columns on and off (several, like Phone, Email and Chase-ups, start hidden). Your choice is remembered per table on this device.
- **Row actions** — the icons at the right of each row (hover to see what each does). On a phone they collapse into a single **:** button that opens a sheet of larger buttons.
- **Long lists** — tables render 200 rows at a time; the footer offers **Show more** and **Show all**.

TIP

Followed a link and now the register shows a single record? That's the focus filter — a banner reads "Showing quote #..." or similar. Click **Clear filter** to get the full register back.

8. Leads

The Leads page is your register of incoming enquiries: who asked, what for, where, who's handling it, and what happened to it. Nothing here is a price yet — a lead becomes a quote with one click, and from then on its status advances by itself as the deal progresses.

Adding a lead

- 1 Open **Leads** and click **Add Lead** (top right).
- 2 Fill in **Customer name** — the only required field. You can pick an existing client or type a new name.
The **Save** button stays greyed out until there's a name.
- 3 Add anything else you know: **Date received**, contact details, **Job location**, **Subject**, **Lead source**, **Assigned to**, **Estimated value (£)** and **Notes**.
- 4 Click **Save** — you'll see "Lead added."

TIP

Contact details you type on a lead travel forward automatically: when the lead becomes a quote and then a contract, any blank contact fields are filled in from here — without ever overwriting something already entered.

Converting a lead to a quote

- 1 Click the arrow icon on the lead's row (tooltip **Convert to quote**), or open the lead and click **Convert to quote**.
- 2 You land on the Quotes page with the **Add quote** dialog open and pre-filled from the lead — client, site, source, salesperson, value and contacts — with today's date and the next quote number already allocated.
- 3 Adjust anything, then click **Save**.
Nothing is created until you save — closing the dialog abandons the conversion harmlessly.
- 4 On save, the lead links to the new quote and its status moves to **Quoted** by itself.

Once a lead has a quote, the same row button reads **Go to quote** — and the **Quote #** and **Contract # (won)** columns are clickable links straight to those records. When a contract is eventually raised from the quote, the lead marks itself **Won** and the contract number is stamped onto it.

Lead statuses and row colours

STATUS	ROW COLOUR	MEANING
New	☐ White	Just arrived — nobody has priced it yet
Quoted	☒ Light teal	A quote has gone out (set automatically on conversion)
Emailed / Called Follow Up	☐ Amber	Chased, waiting on the client
Won	☒ Green	A contract has been raised (set automatically)
Lost	☐ Red	Went elsewhere
Not Our Service / Not Our Area	☐ Pale amber	Declined — wrong kind of work or too far away
Dead	☐ Grey	Gone quiet for good

If something's not right

- The Save button is greyed out in the lead dialog

Customer name is empty — it's the only required field.

Type or pick a customer name and Save enables immediately.

- "Failed to add lead." / "Failed to save." / "Failed to delete."

The save or delete couldn't reach the server.

Check your internet connection and try again. If it keeps happening, contact your administrator.

■ **The table says "No leads yet" but leads exist**

Your search text or a column filter is excluding everything.

Clear the search box, and click **Clear all filters** if any gold filter chips are showing above the table.

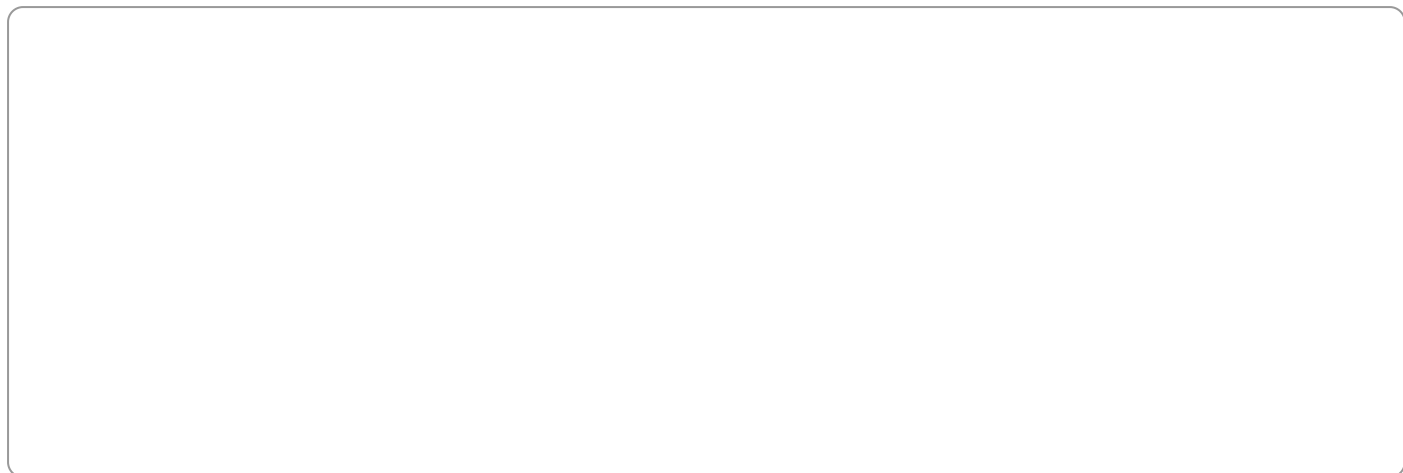
■ **Amber banner: "Couldn't load leads..."**

First-time setup: the leads data table isn't published in the app's back end yet.

This only appears on a brand-new installation — ask whoever set up the app (or email Peter) to publish it, then reload the page.

9. Quotes

The quote register holds every price you've given: who quoted it, what it's worth, where it stands, and a log of every chase. The whole register is colour-coded by status, so anything gone cold is visible from across the office.



The quotes register — status chips and row tints make the state of every quote readable at a glance.

Adding a quote

- 1 Click **Add Quote** (top right). The dialog opens with today's date, and **Quote number** briefly shows "Allocating..." while the next number in sequence is fetched.
It fills in by itself — or you can overtype your own number at any time.
- 2 Complete the required fields (marked *): **Quote number**, **Client**, **Sector**, **Lead source**, **Quoted by**, **Status** and **Value (£)** — the value must be greater than zero.
- 3 Optionally add **Site**, contact details and **Feedback**.
- 4 Click **Save**.
If anything required is missing, the dialog footer lists it ("Required: ...") and the save is refused with "Please complete: ..." naming exactly what's needed.

Recording chase-ups

- 1 Open the quote (click its row) to see **Edit quote**.
- 2 In the **Follow-ups / chase-ups** section at the bottom, fill in the date, **By** (who chased) and **Outcome**, then click **+** to add it to the log.
- 3 Click **Save**. The **Chase-ups** column (switch it on under **Columns**) shows the count per quote.

Turning a won quote into a contract

- 1 Open the quote and click **Create contract** (bottom left of the dialog).
- 2 The Contracts page opens with **Add contract** pre-filled from the quote — client, site, sector, source, salesperson, value, contacts — and the next contract number allocated.
- 3 Click **Save**. Any lead carrying this quote number moves itself to **Won** and is stamped with the new contract number.

Quote statuses

STATUS	CHIP	WHEN TO USE IT
Quoted	 Indigo	The price has gone out; row tinted light teal
Emailed Follow Up	 Amber	Chased by email; row tinted amber
Called Follow Up	 Amber	Chased by phone; row tinted amber
Won	 Green	The job's yours — create the contract
Lost	 Red	Went to someone else
Not Our Service / Not Our Area	 Grey	Declined to quote properly
Dead	 Dark grey	No answer, ever

The status list itself is yours to change under **Settings** → **Quote Statuses**. A brand-new quote saved without picking a status shows a neutral grey "Issued" chip — pick one of the listed statuses to get the proper colour.

If something's not right

■ "Please complete: ..." when saving a quote

A required field is blank, or isn't greater than zero.

The message lists exactly what's missing — fill in each named field and save again.

■ The quote number shows "Allocating..." and stays empty

The automatic numbering couldn't fetch the next number (usually a connection blip).

Just type the number yourself — the field accepts manual entry at any time, and the sequence picks up from whatever you enter.

■ Only one quote is showing

You followed a link from another page, so the register is focused on that one record — there's a banner reading "Showing quote #...".

Click in the banner to see the full register.

■ "Failed to save quote." / "Failed to delete."

The server request failed.

Check your connection and try again; if it persists, contact your administrator.

10. Contracts

A contract is one confirmed piece of work for one client at one site. It's the record everything else hangs off: invoices, proformas and credit notes are raised against it, and its client, site and contact details are the master copy shared across every related record.

Adding a contract

- 1 Click **Add Contract** — or better, open the won quote and click **Create contract** so everything is pre-filled.
- 2 **Contract number** shows "Allocating..." then fills with the next number in sequence. You can overwrite it.
- 3 Pick the **Quote number** if the work was quoted — **Contract value (£)** auto-fills from the quote's value.
A figure you type yourself is never overwritten by the auto-fill.
- 4 Complete client, site, sector, source and contact fields, and tick **VAT zero-rated** and **VAT form returned** if they apply.
- 5 Click **Save**.

GOOD TO KNOW

If you type a client name that isn't set up yet, the contract still saves — and a new-client request is raised for you automatically, with the approvers emailed. You'll see the confirmation in a toast.

Raising documents and seeing what's billed

Open any contract and use the buttons at the bottom left — **Invoice**, **Proforma** or **Credit note** — to start a new document pre-filled from the contract. The **Documents raised** panel in the same dialog lists everything already billed, newest first, each with a status badge (grey *Draft*, red *Not Paid*, orange *Part Paid*, green *Paid*, purple *Credit*); click a line to jump straight to that document.

One correction, everywhere

Fix a client name, site or phone number on the contract and save — the correction is pushed to the contract's quote, its invoices and proformas, the originating lead and the job diary. A toast confirms it: "Details updated on N other records for this contract." Enter details once, correct them once.

VAT zero-rated jobs

Tick **VAT zero-rated** on jobs that qualify for zero rating. Until you also tick **VAT form returned**, the contract's row is highlighted amber and the **VAT form** column shows a **Pending** badge — a standing reminder to chase the client's certificate. Once returned, the badge flips and the highlight clears.

If something's not right

■ A contract row is highlighted amber

The contract is VAT zero-rated and the client's VAT form hasn't been recorded as returned.

Chase the client for the form, then open the contract and tick **VAT form returned**.

■ The contract value keeps showing the quote's figure

The value auto-fills from the linked quote whenever the field is empty.

Type your own figure over it — a manually entered value is never overwritten.

■ Save is greyed out in the contract dialog

Contract number is still blank.

Wait a moment for the automatic number to land, or type one yourself.

11. Prospecting

Prospecting is a call list that builds itself. Any client you've invoiced before but haven't worked for within your prospecting period (six months, unless you change it) appears automatically, biggest spenders first. Ring them, log the call, and when a contract is raised they drop off the list on their own — nothing to tidy up.

Working the list

- 1 Read the four boxes across the top: **Prospects**, **Past work** (total historic £), **Due a call** and **Never contacted**.
- 2 Narrow the list with the filter buttons — **All**, **Due a call**, **Never contacted**, **Quoted in period**, **New prospects** — or the search box.
- 3 Read the cards by colour: white means nobody has rung them yet; amber means contact made and in hand; rose means a follow-up is now due; green means they're back on the books.
- 4 Click **Log contact** after each call (next section), and **Quotes / contracts / invoices** to see a prospect's full history before you dial.

Logging a call

- 1 Click **Log contact** on the prospect's card.
- 2 Fill in the **Date** (defaults to today), **How** (Call, Email, Visit, Letter, WhatsApp or Other), **Spoke to**, **Outcome** and **Status now**.
- 3 Leave **Follow up on** at its default of two weeks ahead — or clear it if no follow-up is needed.
- 4 Click **Save contact**. When the follow-up date arrives, the card gains a rose **Due** badge and jumps to the top of the list.

Brand-new companies (not past clients) are added with **New prospect** — they carry a gold **New** badge and always show on the list. **Remove** takes a prospect off the list without deleting anything — it stays on file and can come back.

The Monday-morning email

Optionally, CrewQCI emails a "Top prospects this week" digest every Monday: follow-ups promised for the week (overdue ones flagged red) plus the best-value clients nobody has rung. Set it up under **Settings** → **Prospecting**:

- 1 Set the **Prospecting period (months)** — not worked for in this long means due a call — plus **Ignore below (£ historic work)** and **Top prospects in the email**.
- 2 Turn on **Send Monday email** and fill in **Email goes to** (no address here means no email is sent) and optionally **Copied to**.
- 3 Click **Test** to send yourself a sample, then **Save changes**.

TIP

The email and the page use the same engine, so Monday's list always matches what you find when you open Prospecting. If there's genuinely nothing to chase, no email is sent at all — an empty digest is deliberately never delivered.

If something's not right

■ No Monday email arrives

Either **Send Monday email** is off, **Email goes to** is blank, or there was nothing to chase that week — an empty email is never sent.

In **Settings** → **Prospecting**, switch the email on, fill in the recipient, click **Save changes**, then use **Test** to confirm delivery.

■ The Test button reports "Forbidden"

Sending the test digest is admin-only.

Ask an Admin or Super Admin to press it, or have your own tier raised.

■ "Allow pop-ups to print the call sheet"

The printable call sheet opens in a new window and your browser blocked it.

Allow pop-ups for this site in your browser settings, then choose [Print call sheet](#) again.

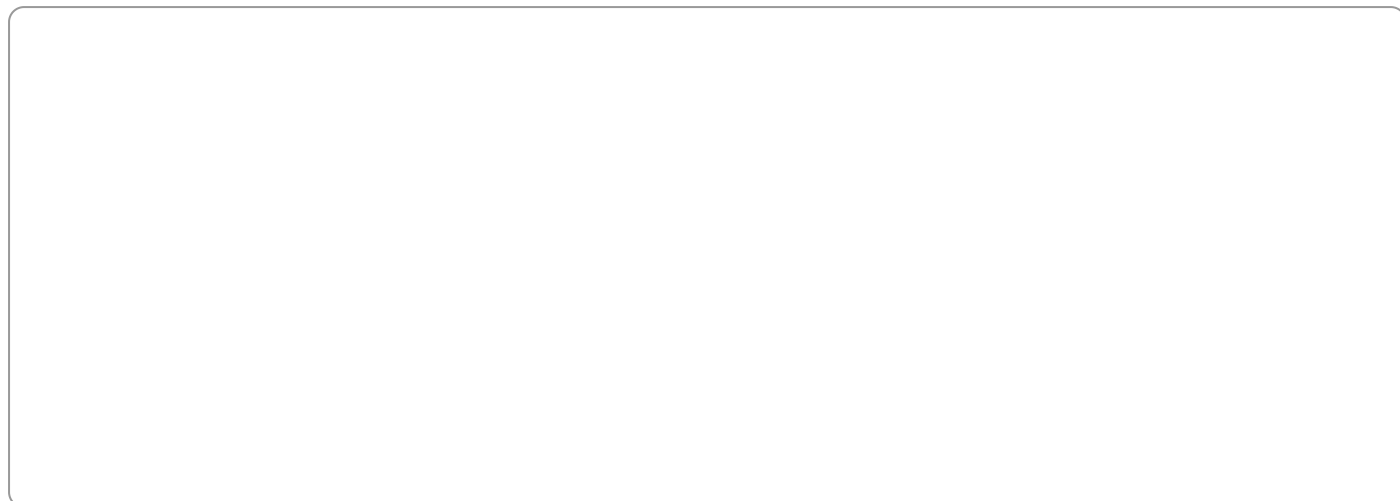
■ "Showing the top 200 of N dormant clients"

More dormant clients qualify than the page shows.

Raise the [Ignore below](#) figure in **Settings** → **Prospecting** to focus the list on clients worth the call.

12. Invoicing

The **Sales Invoicing** page is one register of every issued invoice and credit note: what's been paid, what's owing, what's overdue, and what's gone to Sage. Payments, credit notes, retention posting and the Sage export all start from here.



The invoice register — row colours show payment state; the gold band marks the key money columns.

Reading the register

ROW / CHIP	COLOUR	MEANING
Not Paid	 Pale yellow row, red chip	Nothing received yet
Overdue	 Red row	Unpaid and past its due date
Part Paid	 Pink row, orange chip	Something received, balance still owing
Paid	 Green row	Payments, discount and retention together cover the total
Credit	 Purple row	A credit note (shown with a CR prefix)

The status works itself out from the figures — you never set it by hand. **Owing** is the total minus payments, discount and retention. The **Due Date** comes from the invoice date and the Terms: "On Rec" means 3 days after the invoice date; "30 Days" (or any "N Days") means N days after the *end of the invoice month*. Reverse-charge documents show **Rev Chg** in gold under the VAT figure, and the **In Sage** column gains a tick once a document has been through a Sage export.

Filter with the buttons above the table — **All**, **Unpaid / Part Paid**, **Overdue** — or tick **Not yet exported to Sage**. The row icons, left to right: view/print the document, record a payment, raise a credit note, post the retention (shield), edit, delete.

Raising an invoice

- 1 Click **New Invoice** (top right). The invoice number fills in automatically — or type your own.
A typed number is refused at save if it's already in use; the suggested one is re-checked at save so two people can never get the same number.
- 2 Pick the **Client** and check the address block and contact details it fills in. The address here is the printed "Bill To" — anything you edit is saved back to the client record too. Picking a CIS-registered client ticks **Reverse charge (CIS)** for you.
- 3 Fill in **Site**, **Contract no.**, **Terms** (they set the due date) and any **Order no. (client PO)**.
- 4 Either type the **Net (£)**, or click **Add line** and enter Qty, Details and Unit price per line — Net then becomes the sum of the lines and locks.
- 5 Check the VAT: leave **VAT rate (%)** at 20, change it, or tick **Reverse charge (CIS)** for CIS work — VAT becomes £0 and the document prints the proper reverse-charge wording.
- 6 Enter a **Retention (%)** if the contract holds retention.
The retention due date defaults to one year after the invoice date.
- 7 Optionally add **Work carried out** dates and a printed **Notes** line (e.g. "Nil Retention"), and click **Preview PDF** to see exactly what will print.
- 8 Click **Save invoice**. If you entered a retention, a prompt offers to post it to the Retentions register — see Retentions.

TIP

Preview PDF works before saving and includes your unsaved edits — check the document looks right before it exists. And if you make a mistake anywhere on this page, the app-wide Undo button can take it back: creating, editing, deleting and credit notes are all recorded.

Recording payments

- 1 Click the banknote icon (**Record payment**) on the invoice row.
- 2 Enter the **Amount paid (£)** — the *running total received to date*, not just the latest cheque. For a second part-payment, enter the new combined total.
- 3 Add any **Discount (£)** or **Retention amount (£)** — both count towards settling the invoice.
- 4 Check the live "owing after these entries" figure, then click **Save**. The row's chip and colour update at once.

Credit notes

Two routes, one result. The quick route: click the minus-circle icon on an invoice row, enter the **Net to credit (£)** and who it's **Credited by**, and click **Raise credit note** — the credit applies to that invoice immediately (its paid figure rises, so the owing figure drops). The standalone route: **New Credit Note** at the top of the page, where **Against invoice** is optional — pick the client first and their invoices appear.

Credit notes share the invoice number sequence and show with a CR prefix, a grey **Credit** chip and a purple row. Every application leaves an audit line in the invoice's notes, and editing an issued credit note re-applies it properly — backed out of the old invoice, applied to the new one.

Draft documents from CrewBook

If your firm also runs CrewBook, coordinators can raise *draft* invoices, credit notes, proformas and applications from a job — without a document number. Drafts wait in a **Draft documents** panel at the top of the Invoicing and Proformas pages, excluded from every figure until issued, and their previews print with a diagonal DRAFT watermark so they can't be mistaken for the real thing.

- 1 Click **Open** on the draft and read the coordinator's note at the top.

2 Add the line items, check the VAT and the **Reverse charge (CIS)** tick, and fill anything missing.

3 Click the green **Issue** button — the next number is allocated, today's date is stamped, and the finished PDF opens ready to print, email or file.

The number field reads "Allocated on issue" until then — numbers are never wasted on drafts.

If something's not right

■ "Invoice number ... is already in use."

You typed a number that already exists in the register.

Change it — or clear it back to the suggested number, which is checked and allocated fresh at save.

■ The saved invoice got a different number from the one first shown

Someone else raised a document while your dialog was open, so the number moved up at save — both documents got unique numbers.

Nothing to fix: the toast ("Invoice ... saved.") always states the final number.

■ The Net (£) box is greyed out

Line items are present — Net is the sum of the lines.

Edit the line amounts, or remove all lines (the × on each) to type Net directly.

■ A row has no document icon, so there's no PDF to print

The row was imported from the old workbook — the app didn't produce its document, so it can't reproduce it.

Find the original PDF in your SharePoint filing. Documents raised in the app always have the icon.

■ The number field says "Allocating..." and Save is disabled

The register scan hasn't come back yet — slow connection, or a very large register.

Wait a few seconds, or type a number manually.

■ "Failed to issue — nothing was written. Try again."

Issuing a draft didn't complete — the draft is untouched.

Click again: no number was used and no document was created, so there's nothing to clean up.

■ A coordinator raised a draft but no email reached the office

No "Draft notifications email" is set in Settings, so the notification was skipped.

Set the address in **Settings** → **Bank & document text** → **Draft notifications email**.

The draft itself always appears in the Draft documents panel regardless.

13. Printing, emailing and filing documents

Every document raised in the app opens in a PDF preview — click the document icon on any register row, or **Preview PDF** inside a dialog. From the preview you can **Print**, **Download PDF**, **Email...** the client, or **File to SharePoint**.

Emailing a document to the client

- 1 Open the document preview and click **Email...**.
- 2 Check the **To** address — pre-filled from the client record where known.
- 3 Optionally add a **Message**, which is included in the email.
- 4 Click **Send**. The client gets a branded email under your company name with a download button (the link lasts 7 days), and the send is stamped on the record — hover **Email...** later to see "Last emailed to ... on ...".

Filing to SharePoint

With a SharePoint site name set in Settings, **File to SharePoint** drops the finished PDF into the right folder automatically — invoices into "Invoices *year*", credit notes into "Credit Notes *year*", and so on under "Quotes, Contracts & Invoices". Once filed, the button reads **Re-file**; re-filing after an edit deliberately overwrites the earlier PDF of the same name.

Your branding on the documents

Company details, bank details, logo and footer text on every PDF come from Settings. Before issuing your first real document, open **Account** → **Document samples** and click through the **Invoice**, **Credit Note**, **Proforma** and **Application** tabs — the samples print with exactly the details real documents will use, without creating anything. Anything wrong or missing is fixed under **Settings** → **Company details (documents)** and **Settings** → **Bank & document text**.

If something's not right

- "Failed to send the email. The document was NOT sent."

The email service call failed — nothing reached the client.

Try again; if it keeps failing, use [Download PDF](#) and send it from your own email.

- "SharePoint filing is not configured — set the SharePoint site name in Settings."

No SharePoint site name has been saved in your company settings.

An administrator sets it in Settings. Until then, use [Download PDF](#) and file manually.

- "SharePoint filing failed... Check the folder exists."

The year folder (e.g. "Invoices 2026") doesn't exist in SharePoint yet, or the upload was rejected.

Create the folder in SharePoint under "Quotes, Contracts & Invoices", then click

[Re-file](#).

- The PDF generates without your logo

The "Logo image URL" in Settings is blank, broken, or its host blocks image use.

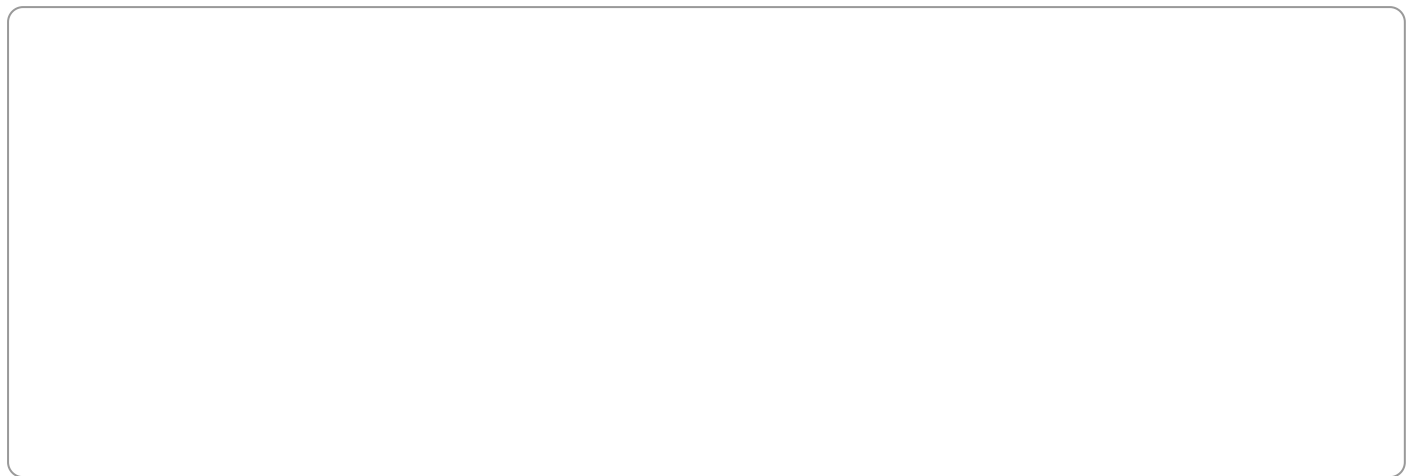
Documents generate fine without a logo. To fix it, update [Logo image URL](#) in Settings to a working, publicly reachable image address.

- "Could not generate the document."

Close and reopen the preview. If it persists, check the record for unusual data and email Peter with the document number.

14. Proformas and applications for payment

Both live on the **Proformas/Applications** page, and both ask for money before a VAT invoice exists — but they're different animals. A **proforma** is a letterhead-style request, typically for a deposit before works start, that later converts into an invoice. An **application for payment** is the QS-style staged claim used on contract work — numbered per contract (App 1, 2, 3...) with Tender / Previous / Current columns — which is *certified* into a Payment Certificate / VAT Invoice when the money is agreed.



The shared register — statuses run Draft, Open, Converted (green) and Dead (grey).

Raising a proforma

- 1 Click **New Proforma** — the number fills in automatically (proformas and applications share their own sequence, separate from invoices).
- 2 Fill the required fields: **Client**, **Contract no.**, **Prepared by**, and a Net (or add line items — Description of works, Area/Qty, Rate, Total).
- 3 Optionally set **Work due for completion** and the printed **Terms paragraph** (e.g. "Terms net — 50% to be received prior to works commencing...").
- 4 **Preview PDF** to check the letterhead, then **Save proforma** — it joins the register as **Open**.

Raising an application for payment

- 1 Click **New Application** and fill in **Client**, **Contract no.** and **Prepared by**.

2 Click **Add line** under **Application items** and fill each row's Tender, Qty, Unit, Previous and Current figures.

Net is the sum of the *Current* column — the amount claimed this application. A live Cumulative figure shows per row.

3 Enter any **Less discount (£)**, **CIS tax (£)**, **Retention (%)**, and check the VAT (including **Reverse charge (CIS)**).

4 Save. The **App number** is allocated automatically — one running sequence per contract.

Payments received before conversion are recorded with the banknote icon, exactly as on invoices — the figures carry onto the invoice when you convert or certify, so an invoice raised after a 50% deposit arrives already Part Paid.

Converting and certifying

1 **Check the value first.** The invoice is raised at the document's current figures — edit the proforma or application before converting if the final value differs. The confirmation dialog reminds you.

2 Click the green arrow icon on the Open row — **Convert to invoice** on a proforma, **Certify — raise Payment Certificate / VAT Invoice** on an application.

3 Confirm. The new invoice is dated today and carries over everything: client, site, contacts, terms, figures, the reverse-charge flag, any payments already recorded, and the work dates. The source flips to **Converted** with a link to its invoice.

4 If the application held retention, a prompt offers to post it to the Retentions register — or do it later from the Invoicing page.

A proforma that will never be paid is marked dead with the ban icon on its row (**Mark dead**) — the row greys out and it can't be converted. The same button, now a circular arrow, reopens it.

If something's not right

■ "Missing required fields: ..."

One or more required fields is empty — the toast lists which.

Fill in each listed field (Proforma number, Client, Contract no., Prepared by, and a Net greater than zero) and save again.

■ "This proforma is marked dead."

Dead proformas can't be converted.

Click the circular-arrow **Reopen** button on the row first, then convert.

■ "Couldn't post the retention — post it from the Invoicing page."

The certificate was raised fine, but the retention record didn't save.

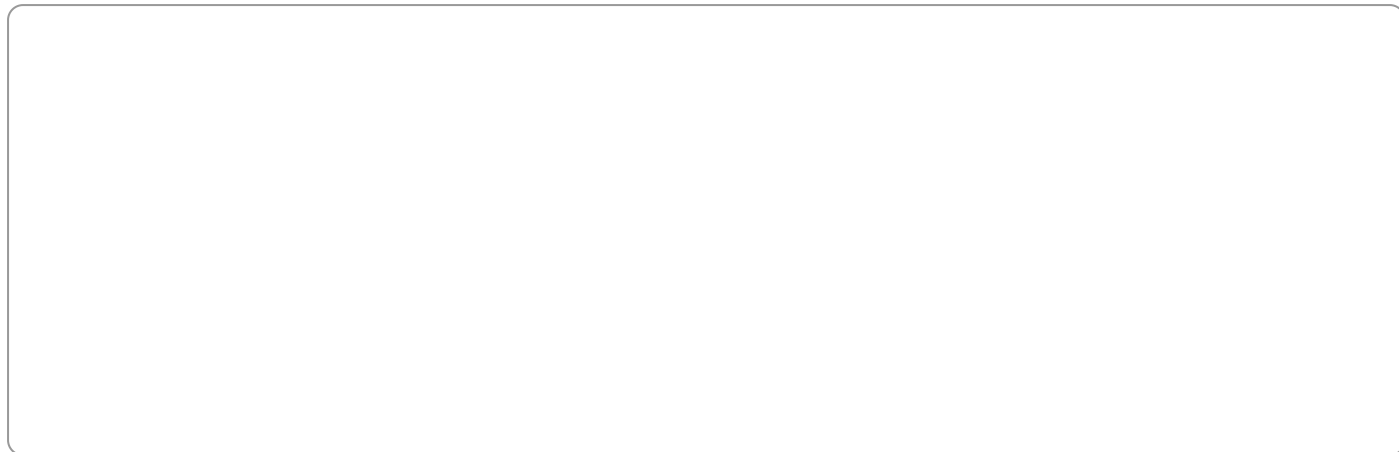
On the Invoicing page, find the new certificate row and use the shield icon or the **Post** button in the Click to Post column.

■ "Convert failed."

Before retrying, check whether the invoice already appeared on the Invoicing page — so you don't raise it twice.

15. Retentions

The Retentions page tracks money your clients hold back from invoices until the end of a defects period. Every retention that hasn't been fully returned is listed with the amount held, anything already returned, what's still outstanding, and the date it falls due — counting down in front of you.



Red = overdue, amber = due within 30 days, green = not yet due. A purple "Part returned" chip marks partial returns.

Getting a retention onto the register

This is the one thing that catches people out: **entering a retention on an invoice does not list it here**. The Retentions page shows *posted* retentions. Post one in any of three ways:

- 1 Accept the prompt when saving the invoice — "Post retention of £X to the Retentions register?" — by clicking **Post retention**.
- 2 Or later, click the shield icon (**Post retention**) on the invoice's row on the Invoicing page.
- 3 Or use the **Click to Post** column there — it reads **Post** when unposted, **Posted** when up to date, and **Click to update** if the invoice's retention figures have changed since posting.

Recording a retention coming back

- 1 Find the row and click **Return**. The dialog shows "Held £X · outstanding £Y".

2 **Amount to return (£)** is pre-filled with the full outstanding balance. Leave it for a full return, or type less for a part return — the dialog warns "Part return — £X stays outstanding on the register."

3 Set the **Date** (defaults to today) and click **Return in full** or **Record part return**.

A full return stamps the returned date on the source invoice too, and the row leaves the page. A part return keeps the row listed with a purple **Part returned** chip and updates the figures. Either way an audit line is added to the notes, and the app-wide Undo can reverse a slip.

WHERE DID A RETURNED RETENTION GO?

Fully returned retentions leave this page by design. Their history lives in **Reports** → **Retention Register** with the Status filter set to **Returned** or **All**.

If something's not right

■ A retention entered on an invoice isn't on the Retentions page

It hasn't been posted — the page only shows posted retentions.

On the Invoicing page, click **Post** in the invoice's Click to Post column, or the shield icon on its row.

■ The return dialog won't accept the amount ("More than the outstanding amount.")

The amount is zero, blank, or larger than what's still outstanding.

Enter an amount greater than £0 and no more than the outstanding figure shown at the top of the dialog.

■ A retention shows no countdown or ageing

It has no due date recorded, so it can't be aged — it's counted as not yet due.

Add the retention due date on the source invoice, then click **Click to update** in the invoice's Click to Post column to refresh the posted record.

- "Invoice N predates the QCI system — its document lives in the SharePoint filing."

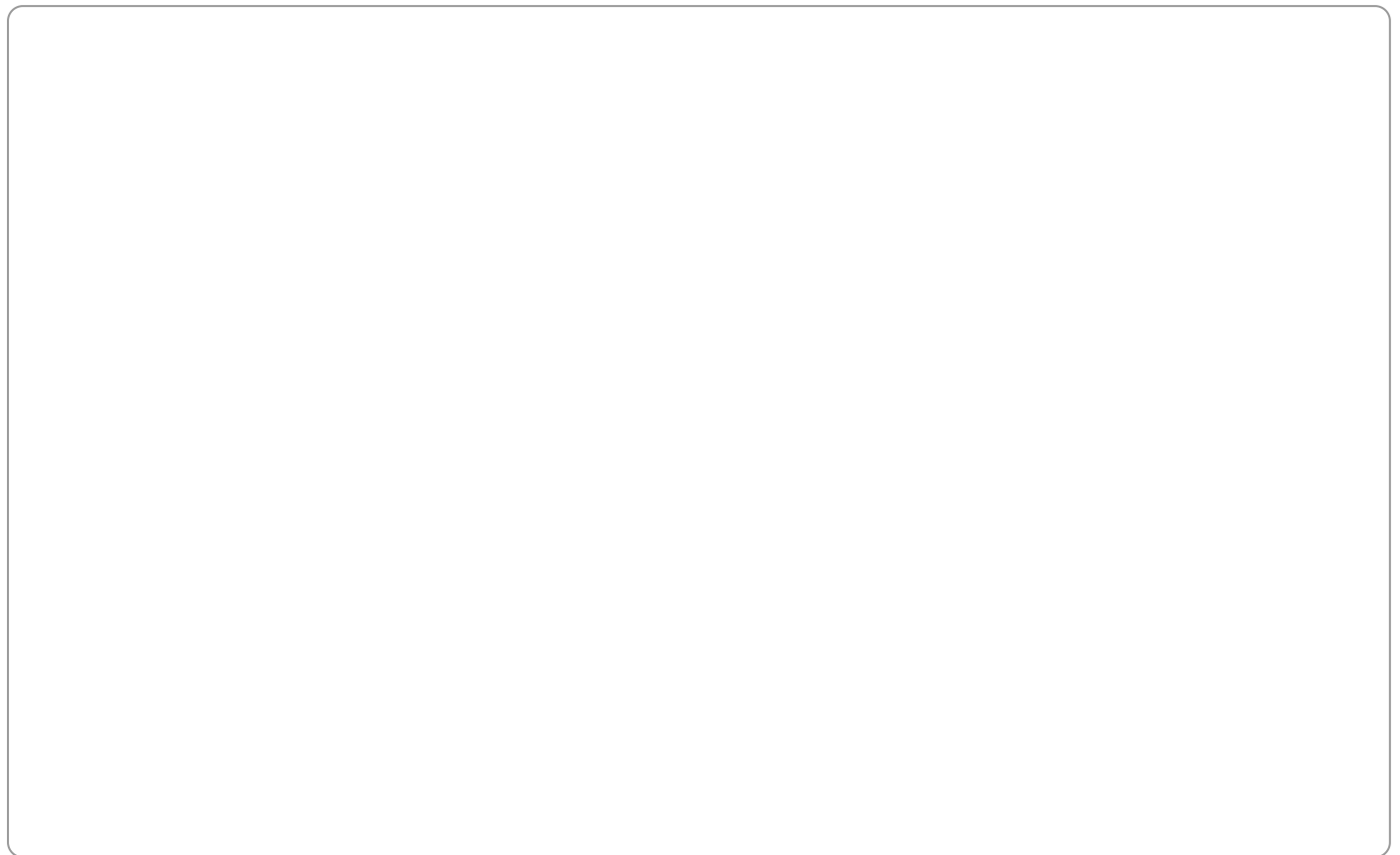
The retention's invoice was imported from the old workbook, so there's no in-app PDF.

Find the original document in your SharePoint filing — nothing is wrong with the retention record itself.

16. Credit control: how chasing works

Credit Control is where the money gets collected. Every open invoice ages from its due date and climbs a **chase ladder** you control — out of the box: a friendly reminder 7 days *before* it falls due, a note on the day, a first chaser at 7 days over, a second at 21, and a final notice at 45. A client gets **one email per run**, at the most severe stage they've reached, under your company name. Everything is driven straight from the invoice register, so the figure on screen is always the figure in the email.

The page has six tabs — **Chasing**, **Statements**, **Retentions**, **Thank yous**, **Credit Limits** and **Settings** — with the total overdue figure and today's queue count always in the header. It's an admin area: Admin and Super Admin tiers only.



The Chasing tab — the queue, each client's stage, and hold reasons written on the row.

Reading the queue

Aged debt tiles run across the top — Not yet due, 1–30, 31–60, 61–90 and 90+ days — and clicking one filters the queue to clients with money in that band.

Each row shows the client, their **stage** (green = Friendly, amber = Firm, red = Final — the same colour appears on the email itself), how overdue, the amount this email chases, and their whole balance. Under the name: their Sage code, the address the chaser will go to, and the invoice numbers being chased.

An amber **paused** badge means the client is due a chaser but is deliberately held back, with the reason written on the row: "Promised payment by ...", "Chasing paused — in dispute", "Balance below the £50.00 chase threshold", "Chased 3 days ago — minimum gap is 7 days", or "No accounts email on the client record". Sending by hand overrides every hold *except* a missing email address and test mode.

Sending chasers

- 1 Click the eye icon on a row (**Read the email before it goes**) — the preview shows the To address, subject and the exact email.
- 2 Click **Send now** — or, for a batch, tick clients and click **Send N chasers**.
The toast reports the outcome per client: "5 sent, 1 skipped, 1 failed".
- 3 Or let the automatic morning run do it — see switching it on safely.

The **Dry run** button asks what today's automatic run would do — "would send N chasers covering £X, hold back N, and send N statements" — without sending a thing. The **History** button shows the audit trail: every email Sent (green), Test (blue), Failed (red) or Skipped (grey), so "why didn't this client get chased?" is always answerable.

One client's credit record

Click a client's name in the queue to open their full picture — outstanding, overdue, credit on account, and every open invoice with the ones that can't be chased greyed out with the reason. Four controls live here:

- **Accounts email** — where chasers and statements go (several addresses separated by semicolons; blank falls back to the client's main email).
- **Promised payment date** — chasing pauses until the day after. If they miss it, chasing resumes automatically.
- **Hold all chasing** — for disputes or instalment plans, with a recorded reason. They stay on statements and on the page; nothing sends automatically.
- **Credit control notes** — the last conversation, who to speak to, portal references.

If something's not right

■ An invoice never appears in the chasing queue

It may have no due date and no usable payment terms, be marked Disputed, fall before the chase start date, or have already had its chaser at the current stage.

Click the client's name to open their ledger — excluded invoices are greyed with the exact reason ("Disputed", "No due date", "Due before the ... chase start date").

■ "Set a sender name ... before sending — a chaser must not go out unsigned."

Every email needs a sender identity: the **Reply-to address** is always required, and this message appears when the **From name** and your company name are both blank, leaving nothing to sign with.

Fill in the Reply-to address and a From name under **Settings → Who it comes from** (or set your company name in the document settings), save, and send again.

■ "The chase history could not be read, so nothing was sent..."

The chase log is the safety interlock that stops the same chaser going twice — if it can't be read, all sending is refused rather than risk repeating one.

This is a setup-level issue: contact whoever administers your installation, then retry. The page still displays; only sending is blocked.

■ "Nothing was sent." after a batch send

Every selected client was skipped — usually because the queue moved on since the page loaded (the server re-checks at send time).

Click **Refresh** and read the per-client messages in the toasts.

■ "N overdue clients with no email address"

That money can't be chased until an address is on file.

Click each client's name and fill in their **Accounts email**.

17. Switching credit control on safely

Letting software email your customers about money is a big step, so the safeguards came first — nothing is sent automatically until the master switch is on, and you can prove the whole setup to yourself before a single client hears from it. The recommended order:

- 1** Under **Settings** → **Who it comes from**, fill in the **Reply-to address** — nothing sends without one — and the **From name**.
Left blank, the From name falls back to your company name from the document settings; if both are blank, nothing sends.
- 2** Put your own address in **Test address**. From now on every chaser and statement is redirected to you and logged as a Test — nothing can reach a client while it's set.
- 3** On the Chasing tab, press **Dry run** to see exactly what today's run would do.
- 4** Set the **Chase start date** to your switchover day. Invoices due before it are never chased automatically — so turning it on doesn't fire final notices at your entire back book.
That older debt stays visible on the page and on statements, to be dealt with by hand.
- 5** Read a few emails with the eye icon and send one or two to yourself.
- 6** Fill in accounts emails for any clients flagged in the "no email address" warning.
- 7** Tick **Send chasers automatically** and save, leaving the test address in place for a few days — the daily summary email shows what would have gone.
- 8** Clear the **Test address** and save. That's go-live.

SENT ONCE, GUARANTEED

Every email is written to a log, and that log is what stops a stage firing twice. Emails sent in test mode don't count as "chased" — once live, those invoices still get their real chaser. And an invoice arriving already 90 days overdue gets *one* final notice, not the whole ladder in reverse.

The rules and the ladder

The **Rules** card sets the guard-rails: minimum balance to chase, minimum days between chasers (7 by default), **Weekdays only**, how many invoice copies to attach per chaser, **Leave disputed invoices alone**, **Exclude retention from the chased amount** ("retention is not due until its release date — chasing it is what annoys a quantity surveyor"), and a **Never chase these clients** list.

The **Chase ladder** itself is fully editable: each stage has a name, its timing in days relative to the due date (negative = before it falls due), a tone (Friendly / Firm / Final), subject, opening and closing paragraphs, an on/off switch, and an optional attached statement. Placeholders like **{client}**, **{total}**, **{count}** and **{oldestDays}** fill in automatically — with grammar helpers so the wording reads right for one invoice or several.

The **Who it comes from** card carries the sign-off (name, title, phone), an internal copy address, the **Daily run summary to** address, and small print for the foot of every email.

The automatic morning run

Once live, a scheduled early-morning job does the whole round: one chaser per client at their most severe pending stage (worst debt first), the monthly statements on or after the configured day, retention release requests, and thank-yous — then emails the office a one-line summary like "5 chasers (£12,340), 3 held back, 0 failed, 12 statements". **Weekdays only** holds back chasers at the weekend but never the statements (month-end on a Saturday still runs) or thank-yous. Per-run caps keep it civilised — chasers, thank-yous and retention requests over the cap are picked up the next morning, and nothing is ever sent twice. Statements are the one exception: with more than 120 due in a run, the remainder wait for the next month (or send them by hand from the Statements tab).

If something's not right

- "Automatic chasing is switched off — nothing goes out on its own."

The master switch **Send chasers automatically** is off. That's the safe default, not a fault.

Everything on the page still works by hand. Turn the switch on under the Settings tab when you're ready — ideally following the go-live order above.

■ No daily summary email arrives

Either **Daily run summary to** is blank, or nothing at all happened that day — quiet days genuinely send no summary.

Set an address under **Settings → Who it comes from**.

■ A client on the "Never chase" list still got chased

The name typed didn't match any name the account answers to.

Names match the forgiving way credit limits match them — aliases, "&" vs "and", company suffixes all count — but check the spelling against the client record and its aliases.

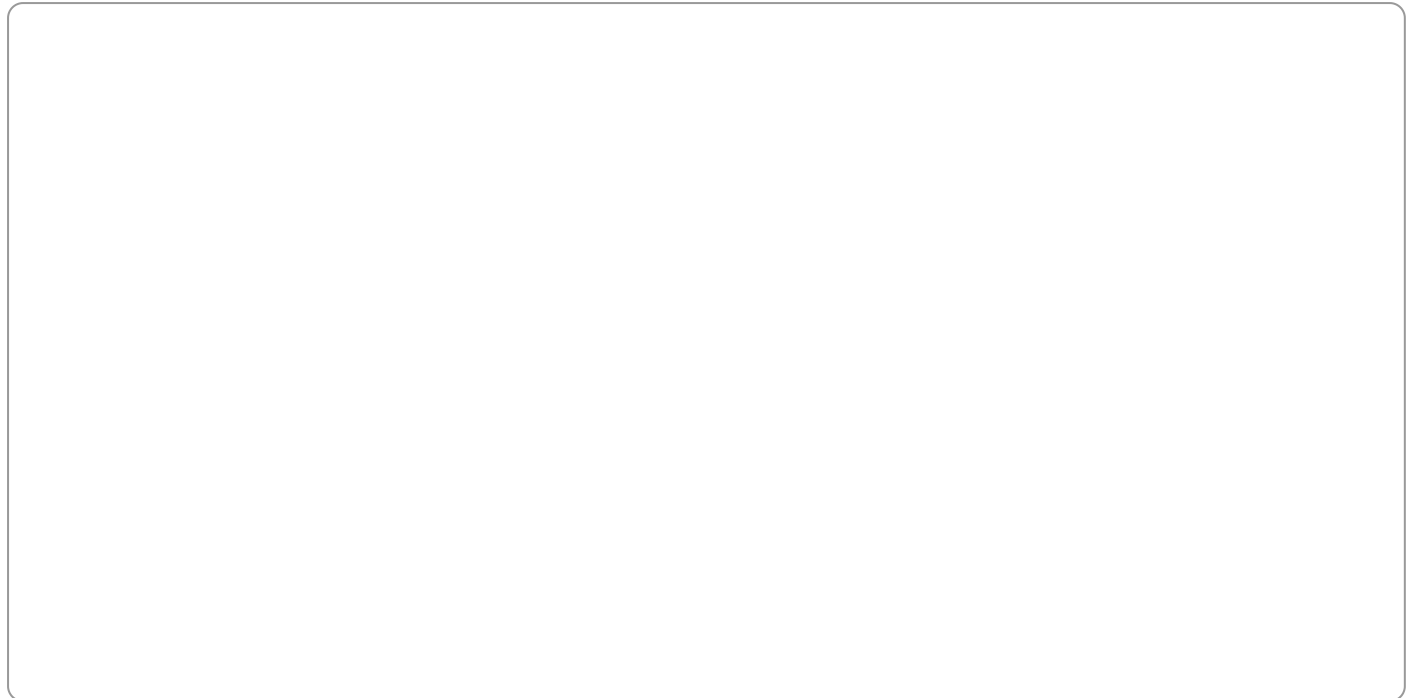
■ Red warning: "N clients would go straight to a final notice."

Nothing has been chased from here yet, and some debt is already deep into the ladder.

Either send those by hand first, or set the **Chase start date** so the old debt is left out of automatic chasing.

18. Statements of account

A statement lists a client's every open item with a running balance, the aged summary and any unallocated credit notes, on a PDF matching your invoice layout. The monthly run can send them automatically on a day you choose (1–28); the same list is on the **Statements** tab for sending by hand.



The Statements tab — who gets one, what they owe, and when they were last sent.

- 1 Click the eye icon (**Preview the statement**) — the dialog has two tabs, **Statement PDF** and **Covering email** — then **Print**, **Download PDF** or **Email statement**.
- 2 For month-end in bulk: tick the clients and click **Send N statements** — the button shows the combined balance in brackets as a sanity check before 200 emails leave the building.
- 3 To schedule it, turn on **Send statements automatically** under the Settings tab and pick the **Day of the month**.

GOOD TO KNOW

The monthly run sends on *or after* the chosen day — a weekend or a missed morning still catches up — but never sends the same client two statements in one calendar month. A client whose unallocated credit covers their balance is skipped with "Account in credit — nothing owing": sending would ask them to pay a negative number.

19. Retention release requests

Retention that has passed its release date gets its own tab — deliberately *not* part of the chase ladder. The client has done nothing wrong, so the email is a level, polite request that repeats gently (at most once per client every 30 days, configurable) until the register records the money returned. Amounts exclude VAT, and part returns are already netted off.

Each row lists what a quantity surveyor needs to release the money: the invoice number, the client's purchase order and your contract number. Preview with the eye icon and [Send request](#), or tick clients and [Send N requests](#) — a manual send deliberately overrides the spacing rule when you need to ask again sooner. Automatic sending has its own switch under the Settings tab.

20. Thank-yous and review requests

The one credit-control email that's good news: a short thank-you when a client settles up — triggered by invoices marked Paid within the look-back window, and sent to the main contact (the person who had the work done) rather than the purchase ledger. Where the throttle allows, it also asks for a Google, Yell or Facebook review while the job is still fresh — a client is thanked every time they pay, but asked for a review at most once every 180 days (configurable), so repeat customers are never pestered.

On the **Thank yous** tab, a green star in the Review column means this email will ask for a review; a grey crossed star means "asked recently — the thank-you goes without". Several invoices settled in one payment produce one thank-you listing them all, and nothing is ever thanked for twice.

THE AMOUNT SHOWN IS WHAT YOU RECEIVED, NOT WHAT YOU INVOICED.

Retention withheld and any discount taken are deducted, so the figure in the email matches what actually reached the bank. An invoice where nothing was received is left out of the thank-you altogether.

Only real payment evidence puts an invoice in the queue: the date it was marked Paid, or failing that the date of the last payment recorded against it. An invoice marked Paid with neither is never thanked for — so editing an old settled invoice, syncing its contract details or adding a note won't drag it back into the list.

■ The thank-you goes but never asks for a review

Either the client was asked within the review interval, **Ask for a review** is off, or no review links are filled in — blank links mean no ask, and there are no defaults.

Under **Settings → Thank you & reviews**, turn on **Ask for a review** and fill in at least one of the Google, Yell or Facebook links.

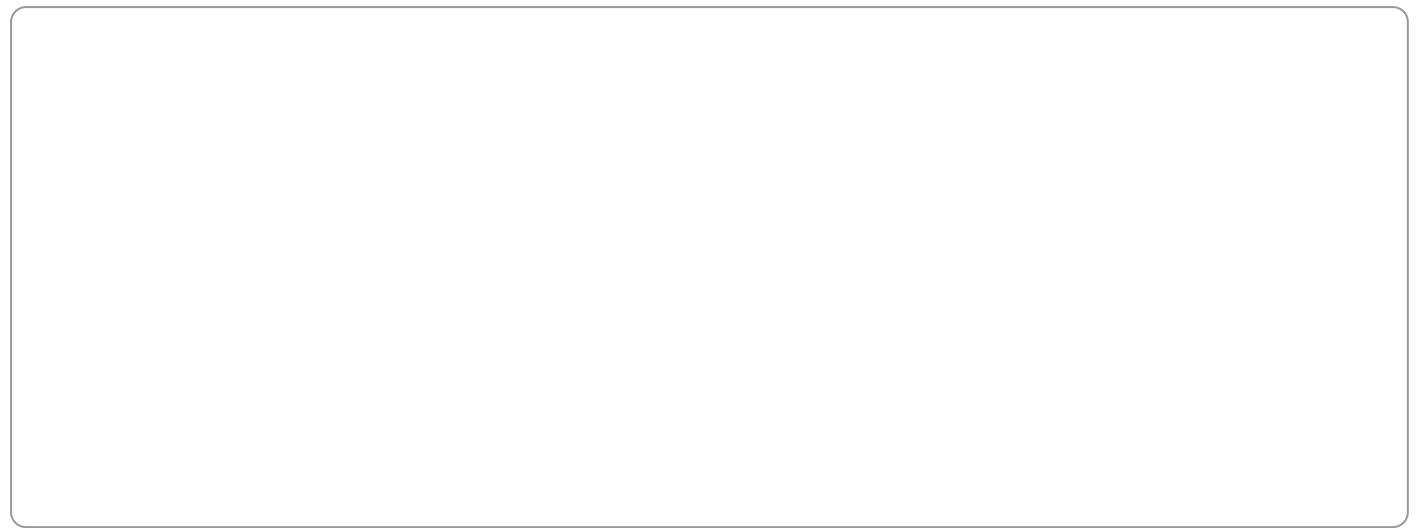
■ Old payments from months ago queue up to be thanked

The invoices carry a recent paid date — usually because they were marked Paid in bulk when you started using the feature.

Set the **Thank-you start date** to the day you switch the feature on — invoices settled before it are never thanked for. The **Look back (days)** window also limits the reach.

21. Credit limits

The **Credit Limits** tab sets each client's limit against their live outstanding balance. Limits live on the client records; balances are computed from the invoice register — **net of VAT**, the exposure a credit insurer covers. **Remaining** shows red when a client is over their limit and amber when less than 10% is left. A purple CIS badge marks CIS-registered clients.



Credit limits — live exposure against the limit, with a pending request awaiting its decision.

Click a row to update or remove a limit, keep **Credit limit notes** (insurer decisions, conditions) and attach documents — each shows who added it and when.

Requests and approvals

- 1** Anyone can raise a request: **Request Limit**, pick or type the client, enter the **Limit requested (£)**, add notes and attachments, and **Send Request**. It's emailed to the credit contacts set in Settings, with a copy to you.
- 2** Pending requests sit in a rose panel at the top of the tab. An admin (or configured stand-in) clicks **Respond** and chooses **Approve** (setting the **Limit granted**, which may differ from the ask), **With underwriter** (keeps it open), or **Decline**.
- 3** **Send Decision** emails the requester — and an approved limit is written straight onto the client record, so credit checks use it immediately.

Going the other way, the flag icon on a client's row raises a **review request** — "this limit can be reduced or removed". It emails the credit contacts and sits in an amber panel until actioned; **Done in Sage** also updates the limit in the app.

If something's not right

- **The Outstanding here differs from the balance on the Chasing tab**

By design: this tab is net of VAT (insurer exposure); Chasing is gross (what the client actually pays).

Both are correct — use the figure that matches the conversation you're having.

- **"No credit request recipients are configured — set them in Settings."**

Nobody is set up to receive credit limit request emails.

An admin should add the credit request recipients in Settings. The request itself is saved and still appears in the pending panel.

- **"No client record matches ... — the limit will not be recorded against a client."**

The request names a client with no matching record, so the approved limit has nowhere to live.

Add the client on the Clients page (or add the name as an alias to the right client), then set the limit from the Credit Limits list.

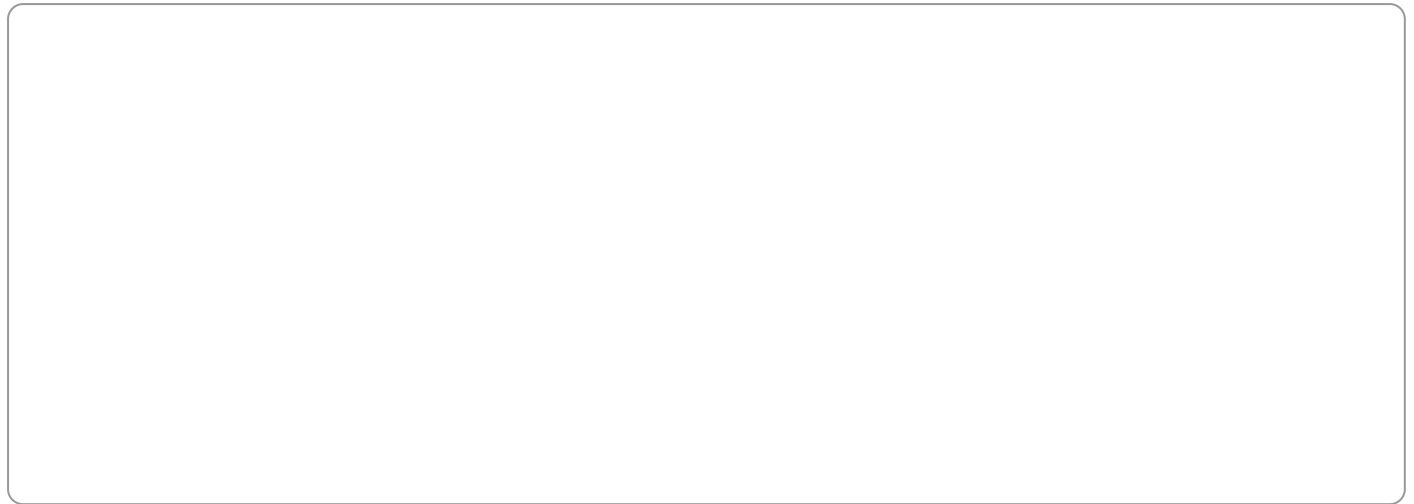
- **"This request has already been approved/declined by ..."**

Two people had the same request open and someone decided it first.

Nothing to do — the earlier decision stands, and the panel refreshes to show it.

22. The client register

One client register sits behind everything: names, addresses, contacts, credit limits, Sage codes, sectors and the CIS flag. The address on the client record is what prints on invoices, proformas and applications — change it once and every new document uses it. Open the register from the **Clients** tile on the Overview, or via **Settings** → **Clients**.



The client register — accounts, codes, limits and flags in one place.

Adding and editing clients

- 1 Click **New Client** (or click any row to edit).
- 2 Type the **Name** — a Sage code is suggested automatically from it (letters and digits, up to 8 characters, unique). Edit it or click **Generate** for a fresh one.
A red "Already used by another client" warning blocks saving — a clashing code would post invoices to the wrong Sage account.
- 3 Fill in the **Address — one line per printed line** (exactly how it prints on documents; the last line is treated as the postcode on Sage exports), contact details and **Credit limit (£)**.
- 4 Tick **CIS registered (reverse charge)** for CIS clients — their invoices default to reverse-charge VAT and export with tax code T21.
- 5 Pick a **Default sector** — it also sets the sales nominal code from your sector mapping.
- 6 Click **Save**.

Two flags worth knowing: **Dissolved / no longer trading** keeps a dead company on file for history but out of prospecting calls, and **Credit Status** records the account's standing (new accounts start at "Needs Checking"). Under **Also invoiced as** you can list **aliases** — other names the client is invoiced under — and their activity and balances roll into this one account.

RENAMING IS SAFE

Change a client's name and save — the new name is carried across every linked job, contract, quote, invoice, proforma and lead ("Renamed on 12 linked records."), so nothing drops off as unlinked and the balances stay whole.

Click a client's *name* (rather than the row) for their **activity register** — every issued invoice and credit note since 2025 with live Invoiced, Credited and Outstanding totals, each document number a link to the register.

Unlinked names and new-client requests

Type a client name on a contract or invoice that matches no account, and CrewQCI notices. An amber warning triangle appears next to the name wherever it's used; a red panel at the top of the Clients page counts every such name. For each one, either **Link** it to an existing account (it becomes an alias, and everything under that name rolls in) or **Set up** a new client with the form pre-filled.

Before it lets a duplicate through, CrewQCI checks the register for near-misses — typos, part-names and trading-name differences, so "K Dean" finds "Kevin Dean" and "FM Conway" finds "F M Conway Ltd". Where it finds any, a **Did you mean:** row of account names appears under the client field; click one to link straight to it. The red panel does the same, offering **Possible match:** buttons that open the link flow.

WHY IT MATTERS

A duplicate account splits a client's balance and credit exposure across two records, so neither shows the true position and chasing goes to the wrong place. It's far quicker to link the name than to merge the accounts later.

Raising a *contract* for an unknown name goes one better: a **new-client request** is raised automatically — a placeholder account is created with the code PENDING and the configured approvers are emailed. On the Clients page, an amber panel lists requests awaiting your **Approve** or **Reject**; approving emails

the setup recipients step-by-step instructions, and the client sits in a grey "awaiting account setup" panel until the real Sage code replaces PENDING.

PENDING BLOCKS EXPORTS

A client whose code still says PENDING can't be exported to Sage — and blocks their invoices from the sales export too. Entering the real account code clears both at once.

If something's not right

■ Save is greyed out in the client dialog

Either the is empty, or the Sage code shows "Already used by another client".

Fill in the name, or change / the code.

■ New-client approval emails never arrive

No approval or setup recipients are configured.

Have an administrator set the new-client approval and setup recipient addresses in the company settings — then use for anything already approved.

■ A "new client" already exists under another name

The same business was typed with a different spelling or trading name.

In the "awaiting account setup" panel click and pick the real account — the name becomes an alias and the duplicate placeholder is removed, so balances aren't split across two accounts.

■ "No clients found"

Clear any search text, and untick ☐ above the table.

23. Reports

Open Reports from **Insights** — the **Reports & exports** button at the top right — or from the **Reports** tile on the Overview. The Reports page is the catalogue: each card opens a full report with filters, key figures, a chart, a sortable table and **PDF** / **Excel** / **CSV** downloads. Every report is calculated from the same engines the credit-control emails use, so a report can never disagree with a chaser that's been sent. Reports are admin-level — Sales and Viewer tiers see "No reports available for your access level."

- **PDF** — a branded A4 document with your logo and the filters printed on it, for handing over.
- **Excel** — a branded spreadsheet with frozen headers, live totals and a second *Basis* sheet listing the filters, assumptions and warnings.
- **CSV** — raw machine values (no £ signs, ISO dates) for importing elsewhere, not for reading.

Downloads always match what's on screen, including the sort order. Filters and sorting live in the web address, so a report can be bookmarked or its link shared and it opens exactly the same way. And every report carries a collapsible **How these figures are calculated** panel — the same plain-English assumptions print on the PDF and in the Excel Basis sheet, so a figure can go to your accountant with its rules attached.

Aged Debtors

Who owes you money, how old it is, and who's already being chased — always "as at today". Three **Detail** levels: **One line per client** (ageing buckets: Not yet due, 1–30, 31–60, 61–90, 90+ days), **Client with invoices** (a headline per client with its open invoices beneath), and **Invoice by invoice**. Filter the **Ageing** (e.g. "90 days and over") and **Chasing** ("Being chased" / "Chasing paused").

MIND THE BASIS

Aged Debtors is **gross, including VAT** — the same figure as on client statements. The Retention Register is **ex VAT**, and retention held is already deducted from the amounts owing in Aged Debtors. Never add the two totals together without converting one; every export prints its basis.

Unallocated credit notes are listed for reference but never deducted from the totals — a warning calls them out instead. Other warnings flag clients excluded

from chasing, missing Sage codes (so you know when it won't reconcile line-for-line with Sage), and invoices whose due date had to be derived from the client's terms.

Retention Register

Retention held against your invoices, when it falls due, and what's already overdue — including, unlike the Retentions page, retentions already returned. The default **Status** filter, **Still held**, matches the Retentions page exactly; switch to **Returned** or **All** for the history. Set **Due** to **Overdue only** to list retention you can now invoice back — the warning line totals it for you.

If something's not right

■ "No records for this period."

The current filters exclude everything.

Set the filters back to their "All" options, as the hint suggests.

■ "A record limit was reached, so this report does not cover every row."

The data behind the report hit a size cap; exports are stamped "INCOMPLETE".

Narrow the date range or filters and run it again — don't rely on the totals of an incomplete run.

■ The Aged Debtors total doesn't match Sage line for line

Some clients have no Sage account code (a warning counts them), and unallocated credit notes aren't netted off here.

Add the missing Sage codes on the Clients page, and read the "How these figures are calculated" panel for the netting rules.

■ "You don't have access to this report."

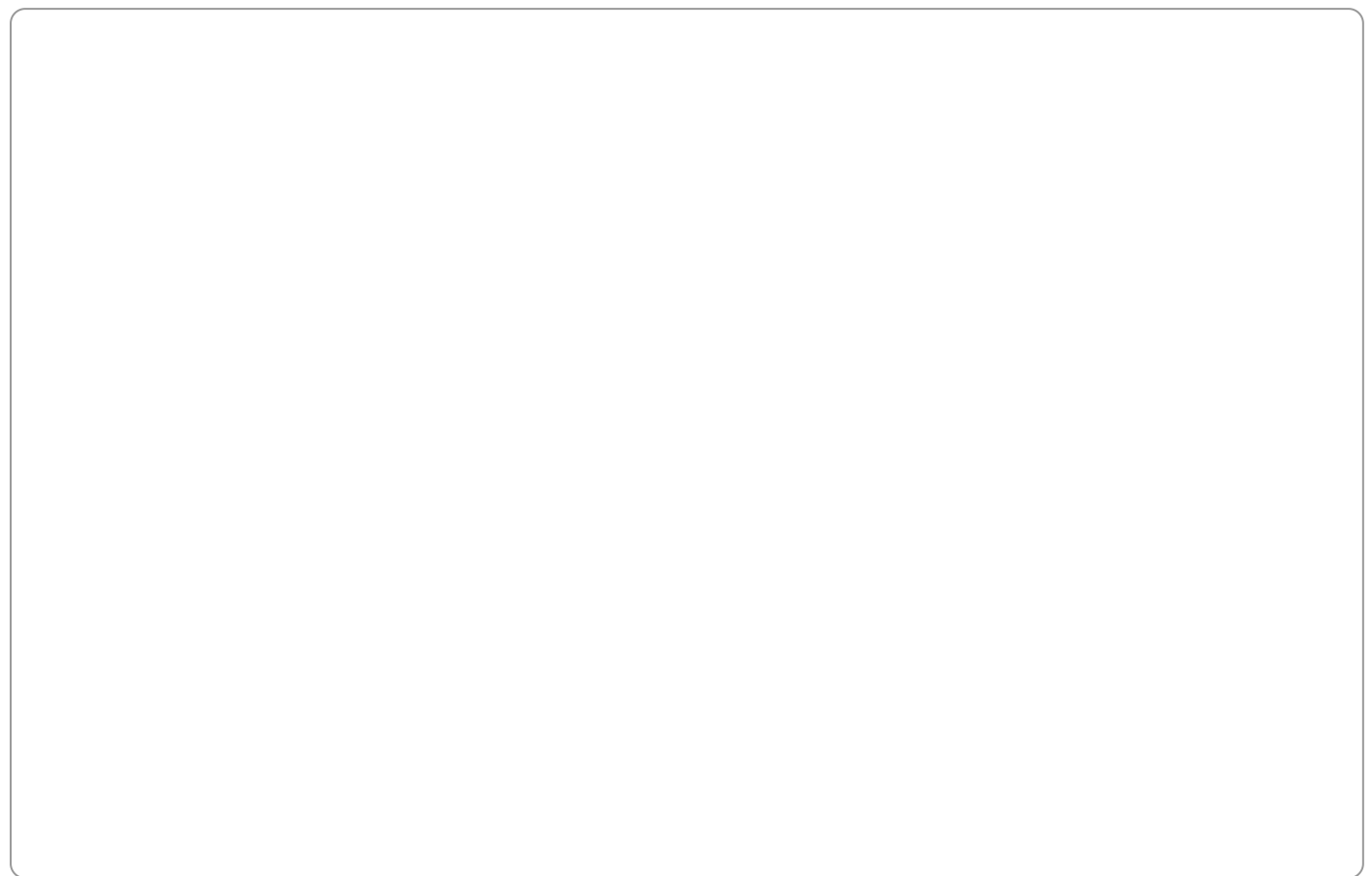
Your access tier doesn't include it — both current reports are admin-level.

Ask an administrator to raise your tier, or to run it for you.

24. Insights

Insights is the charts page — pipeline, win-rate, invoiced revenue and outstanding balances over the rolling last two years — with the **Overdue invoices** list at the top: colour-banded by age (orange over 15 days, pink over 30, red over 45), most overdue first, each invoice number a link straight to the register. Hover any bar or point for the exact £ figure; each card states the period it covers, and draft documents are excluded from every figure.

The Client column shows the **account name** from the register, not whatever spelling was typed on the invoice, so the list lines up with the Aged Debtors report and one client never appears as several rows. Where an invoice was raised under an alias, that name follows in smaller text as (*inv: ...*).



Insights — the charts and the overdue list, straight off the same registers the documents came from.

The charts include lead value and invoiced revenue by lead source, the quotes pipeline by sector, Won vs Lost vs Open, monthly invoiced totals (and this year against last year), and top clients by invoiced value and by outstanding balance

— credit notes netted off throughout. A chart showing "No data yet" isn't broken; it fills in as records are added.

25. Exporting to Sage

Two exports keep Sage in step, and both stamp what they've sent so nothing goes twice.

Customer records (Clients page)

- 1 On the Clients page, click **Export to Sage**. Everything not yet exported with a real code is pre-ticked; tick **Show already exported** to re-send a record.
- 2 Click **Export N** — the CSV downloads in Sage's Customer Record FULL layout (account code, name, address split into Sage's columns, contact, credit limit, nominal, tax code T21 for CIS clients, T1 otherwise).
- 3 Import it with Sage's customer record import. Back in CrewQCI, exported clients show a green tick and the date in the **Exported** column.

Clients marked "Skipped — awaiting account code" have a blank or PENDING code and can't be ticked — Sage needs the account reference as its key field. Fix the code and export again.

Sales invoices (Invoicing page)

- 1 On the Invoicing page, click **Sage Export**, set the **From** / **To** dates and leave **Only documents not yet exported** ticked for a normal run.
- 2 Review the list and untick anything to hold back. Check the amber panel for blocked documents — "no matching client record" or "account code missing or still PENDING" — which are left out and resurface automatically once fixed.
- 3 Click **Export N**. The CSV downloads (invoices as SI rows, credit notes as SC; tax codes T1 for VAT, T21 for CIS reverse charge, T0 for zero-rated) and each document is stamped with the export date.
- 4 Import the CSV into Sage as audit trail transactions — once only.

The nominal code per row comes from the sector's configured code first, then the client's default nominal, then 4000. Drafts never export.

If something's not right

■ "N documents are blocked from this export..."

The document's client has no matching record, or its account code is blank or still PENDING.

Add the real account code on the Clients page (or Link the name to the right account), then re-run — blocked documents are never lost, they just wait.

■ "The CSV downloaded but stamping failed..."

The file was produced, but the exported-date stamps didn't save.

Import the downloaded CSV into Sage **once only**. The same documents will reappear next run — untick them (or exclude them by date) so Sage doesn't get duplicates. A "Stamping stopped part-way" message works the same and lists exactly which invoice numbers weren't stamped.

■ The export dialog lists nothing

Everything in the window has already been exported, or the dates/search exclude it.

As the hint says: widen the dates, clear the search, or untick

Only documents not yet exported to re-export.

26. Settings, backups and the little helpers

Open Settings with the  cog in the header, or from the **Settings** tile on the Overview. It's one page of company-wide configuration, saved all together with the single **Save changes** button at the top. It's an admin page (Admin and Super Admin tiers), and saved changes apply across the app immediately.

- **The dropdown lists** — Sectors, Lead Sources, Payment Terms, Quote Statuses and Sales People. Type a value and press Enter to add; click the × on a tag to remove. These drive the dropdowns across the whole pipeline.
- **Sector nominal codes** — one Sage sales nominal per sector, used when invoices export. A blank sector falls back to the client's default nominal, then 4000.
- **Document settings** — the two cards that print on everything:
Company details (documents) (name, address, VAT/UTR/company registration numbers, registered office, phone, email) and **Bank & document text** (bank details, disputes footer, draft notifications email, logo URL, proforma footer lines). Fill these in before issuing documents — blank fields are simply left off.
- **Prospecting** — the reconnection-call options and Monday digest, covered in Prospecting.
- **Clients** — the card at the top links straight to the client register.

Backups

The Backup card on the Settings page takes a complete copy of your company's data — clients, quotes, contracts, invoices, proformas, retentions and credit control — and writes it to *your own* Google Drive, in a "CrewQCI Backups" folder with one file per table plus a manifest. Nobody else's data is in there, and yours is in nobody else's.

- 1 Next to **Save backups to:**, click **My Google Drive**.
- 2 Click **Connect my Google account** and approve in the tab that opens.
- 3 Click **Back up now** and wait for "Backup complete — N records across M tables." The card then shows the last backup date.

MAKE IT A HABIT

Because the backup uses your own Google connection, it can't run on a schedule — put a recurring reminder in your calendar and press **Back up now** regularly. The card always shows the last backup date, so a stale backup is visible. If any table can't be read, the backup deliberately writes nothing rather than leave a folder that looks complete but isn't.

Undo, live updates and what's new

- **Undo** — the round dark button fixed at the bottom-left of every screen. Hover it to see what the next undo reverses; click to undo, or open the arrow for "Recent actions — click to undo to here" and roll back several at once. It keeps up to 15 recent actions, newest first — and the history is per browser session, so don't rely on it after a reload.
- **Live updates** — when a colleague records a payment or edits a client, your screen refreshes itself within a moment (politely waiting until you've finished typing). Reports are the one exception: they have their own Refresh button.
- **What's new** — after an update, a "What's new in CrewQCI" popup lists what changed. **Got it** dismisses it for good on every device.

If something's not right

■ "Forbidden" when running a backup

Backups are restricted to Admin and Super Admin users.

Ask an administrator to run it.

■ "Could not open the connection window."

The browser blocked the Google sign-in tab.

Allow pop-ups for CrewQCI, then click **Connect my Google account** again.

■ **"Backup stopped before writing anything: some of your data could not be read."**

One or more tables failed to download, so no partial backup was written — deliberately.

Try again; if it persists, email Peter. Nothing misleading was saved to Drive.

■ **"Undo failed — please check the record."**

One of the reversals couldn't be applied — usually the record changed in the meantime.

Open the record named in the action label and correct it by hand; the remaining history is kept so you can retry the rest.

27. Troubleshooting index

Every fix in this guide, gathered in one place. Each entry links to the full answer in its chapter — or type what you're seeing into the search box in the contents panel.

Creating your account and signing in

- "Invalid email or password" when logging in
- "Invalid verification code" when registering
- No password-reset email arrives
- "Invalid reset link" or "Failed to reset password"
- "Access Restricted — you are not registered to use this application"

Your company, the trial and subscribing

- You were invited, but you see "Create your company"
- "You already belong to a company"
- The page stays on "Confirming your payment..."
- The team keeps seeing the subscription page after paying

Leads

- The Save button is greyed out in the lead dialog
- "Failed to add lead." / "Failed to save." / "Failed to delete."
- The table says "No leads yet" but leads exist
- Amber banner: "Couldn't load leads..."

Quotes

- "Please complete: ..." when saving a quote
- The quote number shows "Allocating..." and stays empty
- Only one quote is showing
- "Failed to save quote." / "Failed to delete."

Contracts

- A contract row is highlighted amber
- The contract value keeps showing the quote's figure
- Save is greyed out in the contract dialog

Prospecting

- No Monday email arrives
- The Test button reports "Forbidden"
- "Allow pop-ups to print the call sheet"
- "Showing the top 200 of N dormant clients"

Invoicing

- "Invoice number ... is already in use."
- The saved invoice got a different number from the one first shown
- The Net (£) box is greyed out
- A row has no document icon, so there's no PDF to print
- The number field says "Allocating..." and Save is disabled
- "Failed to issue — nothing was written. Try again."
- A coordinator raised a draft but no email reached the office

Printing, emailing and filing documents

- "Failed to send the email. The document was NOT sent."
- "SharePoint filing is not configured — set the SharePoint site name in Settings."
- "SharePoint filing failed... Check the folder exists."
- The PDF generates without your logo
- "Could not generate the document."

Proformas and applications for payment

- "Missing required fields: ..."
- "This proforma is marked dead."
- "Couldn't post the retention — post it from the Invoicing page."
- "Convert failed."

Retentions

- A retention entered on an invoice isn't on the Retentions page
- The return dialog won't accept the amount ("More than the outstanding amount.")
- A retention shows no countdown or ageing
- "Invoice N predates the QCI system — its document lives in the SharePoint filing."

Credit control: how chasing works

- An invoice never appears in the chasing queue
- "Set a sender name ... before sending — a chaser must not go out unsigned."
- "The chase history could not be read, so nothing was sent..."
- "Nothing was sent." after a batch send
- "N overdue clients with no email address"

Switching credit control on safely

- "Automatic chasing is switched off — nothing goes out on its own."
- No daily summary email arrives
- A client on the "Never chase" list still got chased
- Red warning: "N clients would go straight to a final notice."

Thank-yous and review requests

- The thank-you goes but never asks for a review
- Old payments from months ago queue up to be thanked

Credit limits

- The Outstanding here differs from the balance on the Chasing tab
- "No credit request recipients are configured — set them in Settings."
- "No client record matches ... — the limit will not be recorded against a client."
- "This request has already been approved/declined by ..."

The client register

- Save is greyed out in the client dialog
- New-client approval emails never arrive
- A "new client" already exists under another name

- "No clients found"

Reports

- "No records for this period."
- "A record limit was reached, so this report does not cover every row."
- The Aged Debtors total doesn't match Sage line for line
- "You don't have access to this report."

Exporting to Sage

- "N documents are blocked from this export..."
- "The CSV downloaded but stamping failed..."
- The export dialog lists nothing

Settings, backups and the little helpers

- "Forbidden" when running a backup
- "Could not open the connection window."
- "Backup stopped before writing anything: some of your data could not be read."
- "Undo failed — please check the record."

28. Questions people ask

■ What does CrewQCI cost, and how does the trial work?

Every new company gets 14 days free, started automatically when the company is created — no card details taken. After that it's one subscription for the whole company: £55/month or £550/year (two months free), unlimited users. Nothing is charged until the free period ends.

■ How many people can use it?

As many as you like — the price is per company, not per seat. Invite colleagues by email and give each an access tier (who sees what).

■ What's the difference between a proforma and an application for payment?

A proforma is a letterhead-style request for money before a VAT invoice exists — typically a deposit — that converts into a standard invoice. An application for payment is the QS-style staged claim used on contract work, numbered per contract with Tender / Previous / Current columns, certified into a Payment Certificate / VAT Invoice. Both live on the Proformas/Applications page.

■ How do I handle CIS reverse charge?

Tick **CIS registered (reverse charge)** on the client's record once. From then on their documents default to reverse charge: £0 VAT, "REV CHARGE" in place of a VAT figure, the proper HMRC wording printed on the invoice, and tax code T21 on Sage exports.

■ Why do two pages show different balances for the same client?

By design. Chasing, statements and Aged Debtors work in **gross** amounts — what the client actually has to pay, including VAT. Credit limits (and the Retention Register) work **net of VAT** — the exposure a credit insurer covers. Use the figure that matches the conversation you're having.

■ I've made a mistake — can I undo it?

Usually, yes. The round **Undo** button at the bottom-left of every screen reverses your recent actions, newest first — saves, deletions, credit notes, conversions. It keeps up to 15 actions per browser session, so use it before reloading the page. See Undo.

■ Can I use my own document numbers?

Yes — overwrite the suggested number in any dialog. A typed number is respected, but refused if it's already in use. Invoices and credit notes share one sequence; proformas and applications share a separate one, and applications also carry a per-contract App number.

■ Will CrewQCI email my clients without me knowing?

Not unless you switch it on. Automatic chasing is off by default; while a test address is set, every email is redirected to you; and the go-live checklist lets you prove the whole setup before a single client hears from it. Documents are only ever emailed when you press Send.

■ Can I get my data out?

Yes. Reports export to PDF, Excel and CSV; the registers export to Sage-ready CSVs; and the Backup card writes a complete copy of your company's data — every table plus a manifest — to your own Google Drive.

■ **We run the whole firm on CrewBook — is this the same QCI?**

Yes — CrewBook has the same sales area built in, entered via the QCI logo button, plus extras like draft documents raised from jobs. This guide covers the sales side in full; the CrewBook guide covers the rest of the firm.

29. Getting help

The  button in the app's header brings you back to this guide from any page — straight to that page's chapter.

Stuck on something this guide doesn't cover, or found a snag? Email peter@edwardsapps.co.uk — you'll be talking to the person who builds CrewQCI, and the answer usually ends up in this guide for the next person. The exact wording of any error message, and the page you were on, make a fix much quicker.

The app's own legal pages — Privacy Policy, Terms of Service, Cookie Policy — and the document samples live on the **Account** page, behind the round person icon in the header.